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UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

TUESDAY, 20 OCTOBER 2026

18 must-know stories, 18 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 606 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

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MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Special Parliament Session in October to Pass Women's Quota, Delimitation Bills, 2026: Know Features, Importance, Will Govt Have Numbers

The Centre is considering a special session of Parliament in October 2026 to revive legislation on women's reservation and the delimitation Bill after a setback in April 2026. The trigger is the earlier failure of the constitutional amendment bill to secure the required two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha. The core issue involves reshaping India's electoral system through increased women representation and redrawing constituency boundaries while addressing political concerns. The government is seeking support from opposition parties, including the DMK, to secure the necessary majority for the proposed legislation. The 2023 Constitution Amendment Act provides for one-third reservation for women in the Lok Sabha, state assemblies, and the Delhi Assembly. The proposed 2026 bills aim to boost implementation to potentially enforce the quota before the 2029 general election. The Delimitation Bill 2026 seeks to redraw boundaries, with proposals targeting the expansion of the Lok Sabha strength to around 850 members. Southern states have raised concerns that population-based redistribution could reduce their comparative political influence relative to northern states.

When: October 2026 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Centre, Opposition Parties, DMK · **Prelims:** The Constitution (One Hundred and Sixth Amendment) Act, 2023 is also known as the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam.; The proposed Delimitation Bill targets expanding Lok Sabha strength to possibly 850 members.; The earlier constitutional amendment bill failed to secure a two-thirds majority in the Lok Sabha in April 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Addresses the long-standing underrepresentation of women in Indian politics and decision-making bodies.; Reshapes electoral boundaries and potentially expands Lok Sabha strength to reflect demographic changes.*

Static — Delimitation is the act of redrawing boundaries of Lok Sabha and State Assembly constituencies to reflect changes in population, carried out by a Delimitation Commission. Under Article 82 of the Constitution, Parliament enacts a Delimitation Act after every Census. The Constitution (One Hundred and Sixth Amendment) Act, 2023, known as Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, mandates one-third reservation for women in legislative bodies.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Place in news

jagranjosh.com: read the source · also reported by Times of India

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Section 17A PC Act Doesn't Apply To Bribe Demand As It Is Unconnected To Official Duty: Supreme Court

The Supreme Court delivered a judgment clarifying the scope of Section 17A of the Prevention of Corruption Act in bribery cases. The Supreme Court clarified that Section 17A of the Prevention of Corruption Act does not protect public servants accused of demanding bribes, as bribery cannot be construed as part of official duty.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** Supreme Court of India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court ruled that demanding a bribe lacks connection to official duty and does not attract Section 17A.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Prevents public servants accused of demanding illegal gratification from using statutory procedural safeguards as a shield against investigation.; Maintains an operational balance between safeguarding honest bureaucrats and enabling swift action against corrupt practices.*

Static — Section 17A was introduced into the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, via the 2018 amendment to protect honest public servants from malicious inquiries. The provision mandates prior approval from the competent authority before any police officer can conduct an inquiry, inquiry, or investigation into public servants' official decisions. Section 17A specifically covers recommendations made or decisions taken by a public servant in the discharge of official functions or duties.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Ethics & Integrity · Prelims angle: Judgment, Act/Bill/Rules

LiveLaw: read the source · also reported by Deccan Herald

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court says temple property cannot be taken over by government, even for public purposes

The Supreme Court ruled that temple property is held for the deity and cannot be usurped by the government for public purposes or administrative convenience. The dispute arose over 1 acre and 10 cents of land belonging to the Nagapalayam Mariamman-Ponnachiamman Temple in Tamil Nadu's Erode district. In August 2017, a temporary trustee gifted the inam temple land to the state government for constructing a taluk office. Devotees and a hereditary trustee challenged the transaction, arguing it violated the Tamil Nadu Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Act, 1959. The Madras High Court dismissed the challenge in March 2019, leading to the appeal in the Supreme Court. The Supreme Court held that Section 41 of the 1959 Act declares gifts of such inam property null and void ab initio. The court emphasized that the State is only a custodian and regulator of temple properties, not their owner. Considering the taluk office already constructed with public funds, the court did not annul the occupation but converted it into a lease.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** Kodumudi village, Erode district, Tamil Nadu · **Who:** Justices PS Narasimha and Alok Aradhe · **Prelims:** The case involved the Nagapalayam Mariamman-Ponnachiamman Temple in Kodumudi village, Erode district, Tamil Nadu.; The disputed land measured 1 acre and 10 cents and was classified as inam property.; Section 41 of the Tamil Nadu Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Act, 1959, governs the alienation of such property.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the legal status of temple properties as being vested directly in the deity rather than being available for government disposal.; Clarifies the limits of state power in managing religious trusts, emphasizing fiduciary duty and preservation over administrative convenience.*

Static — The Tamil Nadu Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Act, 1959, regulates the administration of Hindu religious institutions and endowments in the state. Inam properties are lands granted historically by rulers, revenue-free or on concessional terms, specifically for religious or charitable purposes. Under Indian law, property dedicated to a deity vests in the idol as a juristic person, and managers or trustees hold it strictly in a fiduciary capacity.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, History, Art & Culture · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source

Governance & Policy

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Amid ECI row, RGI readies for Census exercise

The Registrar General of India directed State and UT directorates to maintain 24x7 social media monitoring cells to track digital discussions ahead of the Census population enumeration phase. The move comes amid concerns over the regular functioning of constitutional bodies like the ECI and protests over voter list revisions that could vitiate official exercises with rumours. The RGI aims to counter misleading narratives in real time, publish authoritative fact-checks, and run a publicity campaign at different levels. RGI Mritunjay Kumar Narayan stated that public awareness campaigns are crucial to establish rapport and ensure a warm reception for enumerators during household visits. The campaign will inform citizens about questions asked by enumerators, explain digital self-enumeration, and reassure respondents of legal confidentiality under the Census Act. The publicity drive will combine national mass-media advertising, state-level campaigns, district outreach, and a potential Republic Day tableau subject to Defence Ministry approval. The Census is being conducted in two phases, namely house listing and housing census followed by population enumeration.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Registrar General of India Mritunjay Kumar Narayan · **Prelims:** The second phase of the Census is known as Population Enumeration.; Population enumeration in Goa, Uttar Pradesh, Punjab, and Uttarakhand will take place from December 1, 2026, to January 4, 2027.; The Union Cabinet approved Rs 11,718 crore to conduct the Census exercise.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the growing challenge of misinformation and digital rumors affecting large-scale state administrative exercises.; Ensures data security, legal confidentiality awareness, and public trust in the country's decennial population headcount.*

Static — The Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, India, is founded under the Ministry of Home Affairs, responsible for conducting the decennial Census. The Census of India is conducted under the provisions of the Census Act, 1948, which ensures legal confidentiality of individual data collected. The decennial Census is the largest administrative and statistical exercise undertaken by the country, providing comprehensive demographic, social, and economic data.

Syllabus: GS2: Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Report/Index

dailypioneer.com: read the source · also reported by The Hindu, The Live Nagpur

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

Cabinet Clears Rs. 53,428 Cr to Boost Social Safety Nets

The Cabinet clearing the massive financial package put the social safety net expansion in the news. The Union Cabinet has cleared a financial outlay of Rs. 53,428 crore to boost social safety nets in the country.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Union Cabinet · **Prelims:** Total outlay approved: Rs. 53,428 crore.; Approving body: Union Cabinet.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for reducing vulnerability and extreme poverty among marginalized communities.; Helps stimulate domestic demand through increased purchasing power for lower-income groups.*

Static — Social safety nets in India comprise various central sector and centrally sponsored schemes aimed at poverty reduction and risk mitigation. Major social protection pillars include food security through the National Food Security Act and rural employment guarantees under MGNREGA. Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) framework is heavily utilized to plug leakages in the delivery of welfare subsidies and cash transfers.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Governance & Policy

TradeFlock: read the source

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

25th SCO Council of Heads of Government Meeting: Raksha Mantri calls for unified action to dismantle the entire ecosystem of terrorism

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh addressed the 25th Meeting of the SCO Council of Heads of Government in Dushanbe, Tajikistan, on October 20, 2026. He called on SCO member states to work together to dismantle the entire ecosystem of terrorism, stating there is no justification or double standards for it. Singh emphasized that terrorism threatens peace, disrupts commerce, radicalizes societies, and deprives youth of opportunities. He recalled Prime Minister Narendra Modi's emphasis at the Bishkek Summit on security, connectivity, and opportunity. India stressed that economic engagement must be inclusive, adhere to sovereign equality, and avoid unnecessary institutional duplication. Singh highlighted India's support for the Multilateral Trade and Economic Cooperation Programme Action Plan for 2026-2030 and stronger supply chains. He reaffirmed that regional connectivity projects must respect sovereignty and territorial integrity, citing the INSTC and Chabahar Port. The heads of delegation adopted the Joint Communiqué, the 2027 budget, and the PMTEC Action Plan, while welcoming new permanent anti-terror and drug bodies. India has been a full member of the SCO since 2017 and announced it will host the first SCO Civilisational Dialogue Forum later this year.

When: October 20, 2026 · **Where:** Dushanbe, Tajikistan · **Who:** Rajnath Singh · **Prelims:** The 25th SCO Council of Heads of Government meeting took place in Dushanbe, Tajikistan.; India has been a full member of the SCO since 2017.; Universal Centre in Tashkent and the Anti-Drug Centre in Dushanbe were established as permanent SCO bodies.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reiterates India's firm stance against cross-border terrorism and terror financing on an international platform.; Reinforces India's commitment to Central Asian connectivity via projects like INSTC and Chabahar Port.*

Static — The Shanghai Cooperation Organisation is a permanent intergovernmental international organization established in 2001 in Shanghai by the leaders of China, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia, Tajikistan, and Uzbekistan. India and Pakistan officially joined the SCO as full members at a summit in Astana in 2017, while Iran became a full member in 2023. The SCO's main objectives include strengthening mutual trust and neighborliness among member states, and promoting effective cooperation in politics, trade, economy, technology, and culture.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Internal Security

PIB: read the source · free copy on greaterkashmir.com · also reported by Hindustan Times, Economic Times, Kanak News Odisha, Times of India, Swarajya

GS2 MAKE NOTES

India Reiterates Offer to Make Its Nuclear No-First-Use Commitment Part of a Multilateral Legal Agreement

India has reiterated its commitment to formalize its 'no first use' nuclear policy into a legally binding multilateral agreement. Congress MP Manish Tewari presented this offer at the United Nations General Assembly First Committee to support disarmament. The core issue highlights India's responsible stance, credible minimum deterrence, and pledge against non-nuclear states. India maintained a voluntary, unilateral moratorium on nuclear testing and supports legally binding security assurances. India and China remain the only nuclear-armed nations to publicly disavow the first use of nuclear weapons. India acknowledged concerns regarding Artificial Intelligence in nuclear command systems, advocating for human decision-making. India regularly tables UN resolutions on reducing nuclear danger and prohibiting the use of nuclear weapons to gain global support.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** United Nations, New York · **Who:** Manish Tewari, Government of India · **Prelims:** Manish Tewari represented India at the UNGA First Committee.; India and China are the only nuclear-armed nations to publicly disavowed the first use of nuclear weapons.; India maintains a voluntary, unilateral moratorium on nuclear testing.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reinforces India's image as a responsible nuclear-weapon state committed to global non-proliferation.; Addresses contemporary strategic concerns like the integration of Artificial Intelligence in nuclear command and control systems.*

Static — India declared itself a nuclear-weapon state following the May 1998 Pokhran-II tests (Operation Shakti). India's nuclear doctrine, adopted officially in 2003, is anchored on 'Credible Minimum Deterrence' and a strict 'No First Use' (NFU) policy. Under India's NFU posture, nuclear weapons will only be used in retaliation against a nuclear attack on Indian territory or Indian forces anywhere.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Defence, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

lokmattimes.com: read the source · also reported by www.nationpathindia.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Russia, Ukraine and the Indian peace push

US President Donald Trump defended his decision to waive specific sanctions and tariffs related to Russia under a national-interest provision. The waiver was issued to avoid jeopardizing ongoing peace negotiations and to keep Moscow engaged at the bargaining table. Trump signed an executive order on October 16, invoking the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026. The waived measures included potential 500% duties on Russian goods and 100% additional duties on goods from major buyers of Russian oil. The decision provides potential tariff and sanctions relief to India regarding its continued purchases of Russian-origin oil and gas. Trump criticized Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy over strikes on Russian diesel refineries, claiming they hurt global fuel markets and US businesses. Zelenskyy argued that easing economic pressure on Moscow would only encourage Russia to continue its military aggression. The US administration stated it will continue to monitor Russian energy purchases and keep open the option of future actions.

When: October 16 to October 18, 2026 · **Where:** United States, Russia, Ukraine, India · **Who:** Donald Trump, Volodymyr Zelenskyy, Vladimir Putin · **Prelims:** The executive order waiving specific measures was signed on October 16.; The legislation involved is the Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026.; The waived measures included a potential 500% increase in duties on Russian goods.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides immediate trade and economic relief to India regarding its imports of Russian-origin crude oil and gas.; Highlights shifts in US diplomatic strategy regarding the Russia-Ukraine conflict and international energy markets.*

Static — The United States imposes comprehensive economic sanctions through executive orders, congressional acts, and agencies like the Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC). Secondary sanctions target third-country entities, such as major buyers of Russian oil like India or China, to deter commercial ties with sanctioned nations. National-interest waivers allow the US President to suspend specific legislative sanctions temporarily if deemed crucial for national security or ongoing diplomacy.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

Frontline: read the source · free copy on outlookindia.com

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Rubio hails ‘great’ meeting with Jaishankar, UAE foreign minister on regional energy security

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio held a trilateral meeting with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and UAE Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan. The leaders discussed regional energy security and the way ahead on shared economic priorities during their meeting. Rubio expressed support for India's ongoing efforts to diversify its energy portfolio despite India continuing to purchase Russian crude oil. Rubio noted that pivoting away from current suppliers is difficult to achieve overnight, acknowledging India's substantial progress in diversification. Rubio stated that the US could act as a source of energy inputs for India and mentioned discussions involving Venezuela and other nations. During his three-day visit to India, Rubio also noted that India and the US are exploring cooperation in defence, security, technology, and critical minerals. Rubio backed talks between the US, Russia, and China on arms control, noting US President Donald Trump's openness to leader-level discussions. Rubio mentioned uncertainty regarding China's willingness to join arms control talks, as Beijing historically waits until matching other nuclear powers.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Marco Rubio, S Jaishankar, Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan · **Prelims:** Marco Rubio is the US Secretary of State.; Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan is the UAE foreign minister.; Marco Rubio arrived in Mumbai for his second visit to India this year.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's pragmatic energy diplomacy and its strategy to diversify energy sourcing despite geopolitical complexities.; Reinforces minilateral cooperation between India, the US, and the UAE in West Asia and Indo-Pacific economic domains.*

Static — India-US bilateral relations span strategic, defence, economic, and technological cooperation, anchored by institutional mechanisms like the 2+2 Ministerial Dialogue. India-UAE relations are built on a Comprehensive Strategic Partnership, encompassing robust trade, energy cooperation, investments, and diaspora ties. India pursues a policy of strategic autonomy in its energy security, importing crude oil from diverse sources including Russia, the Middle East, and the US.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations, Infrastructure & Energy

Hindustan Times: read the source · also reported by Indian Express, DD News, The Hindu, Times of India, Ministry of External Affairs, The Indian Express, NDTV, Business Standard

Economy

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

India-New Zealand FTA comes into effect, removes tariffs on Indian exports

The Free Trade Agreement between India and New Zealand was enforced on October 20, granting Indian goods duty-free access across the entire New Zealand market. The announcement was made via a Ministry of Commerce and Industry presentation cited by ANI. Labour-intensive sectors like textiles, apparel, leather, and footwear benefit from the immediate removal of tariffs of up to 10 per cent. Other sectors including engineering goods, pharmaceuticals, machinery, chemicals, and agricultural products also gain better market access. The agreement provides New Zealand market access across 70 per cent of tariff lines, with India excluding the remaining 30 per cent. For New Zealand, duties on 30 per cent of covered tariff lines are eliminated immediately, while remaining lines see phased reductions over up to 10 years. Under the Strategic Partnership Roadmap, both nations aim to double bilateral trade in goods and services to NZD 7 billion by 2030. New Zealand has also committed to invest USD 20 billion in India over a 15-year period.

When: October 20 · **Where:** India and New Zealand · **Who:** Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agrawal · **Prelims:** The India-New Zealand FTA came into effect on October 20.; India receives 100 per cent duty-free access for its goods exports to New Zealand.; The two countries set a target of doubling bilateral trade to NZD 7 billion by 2030.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Provides significant benefits to Indian labour-intensive sectors like textiles, apparel, leather, and footwear through tariff eliminations.; Encourages robust bilateral investments, including a committed USD 20 billion investment from New Zealand into India over 15 years.*

Static — Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) are treaties between two or more countries to reduce or eliminate import and export barriers, falling under preferential trade areas. Tariff lines refer to individual items listed in a country's tariff schedule, detailing specific customs duty rates applied to imported goods. Tariff-rate quotas (TRQs) allow a specific quantity of a good to be imported at a lower duty rate, while imports exceeding that quota face higher tariffs.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Economy, International Relations, Agriculture & Allied · Prelims angle: Agreement/MoU

Economic Times: read the source · free copy on timesofindia.indiatimes.com · also reported by ThePrint, NRI Affairs, Hindustan Times, BusinessLine, MorungExpress

GS3 MAKE NOTES

AT-1 Bond Write-Down Invalid: Administrator Can’t Exercise RBI’s Regulatory Powers: Supreme Court

The Supreme Court pronounced its verdict on the validity of AT-1 bond write-downs executed by administrators. The Supreme Court ruled that the write-down of AT-1 bonds is invalid because an administrator lacks the legal authority to exercise the regulatory powers of the RBI.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Who:** Supreme Court, Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court ruled the AT-1 bond write-down invalid.; Administrators cannot exercise RBI regulatory powers.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Clarifies the clear boundaries of authority between appointed administrators and central banking regulators.; Safeguards investor rights and prevents arbitrary write-downs of high-risk banking instruments.*

Static — Additional Tier-1 (AT-1) bonds are unsecured, perpetual bonds issued by banks to shore up their core capital to meet Basel III norms. AT-1 bonds carry no maturity date and feature a write-down clause that allows banks to cancel them if capital falls below a threshold. The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) regulates scheduled commercial banks and exercises statutory powers under the Banking Regulation Act, 1949.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Defence, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment, Exercise

Juris Hour: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI injects Rs 1 lakh crore as liquidity tightens before festive season

The intervention was triggered after the weighted average call rate rose 17 basis points above the repo rate ahead of the festive season. The Reserve Bank of India injected Rs 1 lakh crore into the banking system through a variable rate repo auction to ease tightening liquidity. On Monday, the RBI announced a Rs 1-lakh-crore variable rate repo (VRR) auction for the first time since late July after the weighted average call rate (WACR) at 5.67% on Monday, or 17 basis points higher than the repo rate of 5.50%. The central bank will conduct another VRR for Rs 50,000 crore on Wednesday.

When: Monday, 2026-10-20 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** The RBI announced a Rs 1-lakh-crore variable rate repo auction on Monday.; The weighted average call rate was recorded at 5.67% on Monday.; The benchmark repo rate stands at 5.50%.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Shows proactive central bank intervention to prevent sharp spikes in short-term borrowing costs for banks.; Ensures adequate liquidity in the financial system to support credit demand during the peak festive shopping season.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India is India's central banking institution established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. The repo rate is the interest rate at which the central bank lends money to commercial banks against government securities. Variable rate repo auctions are tools used by the central bank to manage short-term liquidity in the banking system.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

Economic Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

FM Sitharaman seeks global framework to address sanctions fallout

The statement was made in the context of economic penalties having severe consequences that extend well beyond their intended targets. Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman has called for the establishment of a global framework to address the collateral damage and fallout caused by economic sanctions. FM calls for multilateral rules as economic penalties have consequences beyond their intended targets

When: 2026-10-20 · **Who:** FM Sitharaman · **Prelims:** Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman called for the global framework.; The demand focuses on addressing the fallout of economic sanctions beyond intended targets.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights India's consistent diplomatic stance on the negative impacts of unilateral economic measures on developing nations.; Pushes for stronger multilateral cooperation to safeguard global economic stability and energy security.*

Static — Economic sanctions are commercial and financial penalties applied by one or more countries against a targeted self-governing state, group, or individual. Multilateral sanctions are imposed by international bodies like the United Nations Security Council under Chapter VII of the UN Charter. Unilateral sanctions are imposed by individual countries or blocs, such as the United States or the European Union, outside UN mandates.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, International Relations, Governance & Policy

Business Standard: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

RBI tightens scrutiny of $1 billion-plus overseas investments amid rupee pressure

The measure was introduced amid ongoing pressure on the Indian rupee. The Reserve Bank of India has introduced stricter scrutiny and detailed due diligence requirements for overseas direct investments exceeding one billion dollars by Indian companies. Banks must now collect and present detailed information regarding these investments to the RBI. This initiative aims to prevent potential losses for both the companies and the Indian economy. The RBI's checklist requires banks to conduct thorough due diligence on the rationale behind each investment.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Reserve Bank of India · **Prelims:** RBI introduced stricter scrutiny for overseas direct investments exceeding $1 billion.; Banks must collect and present detailed information and due diligence on investment rationales to the RBI.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps protect Indian companies and the national economy from risky capital outflows and potential financial losses.; Strengthens regulatory oversight on large-ticket financial transactions during periods of currency depreciation pressure.*

Static — The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is India's central banking institution, established on April 1, 1935, under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934. Overseas Direct Investment (ODI) by Indian parties is regulated under the Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), 1999, and specific ODI rules and regulations. The central bank formulates, implements, and monitors the monetary policy and maintains price stability while keeping in mind the objective of growth.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

Economic Times: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Government to review 2019 mineral policy amid new sector priorities

The Centre is set to review the National Mineral Policy, 2019, to align it with evolving sector demands and new priorities. The review focuses on emerging areas such as critical minerals, recycling, and deep-sea resources. The Mines Ministry has decided to constitute a nine-member committee chaired by the Additional Secretary in the Mines Ministry. The panel is tasked with reviewing the 2019 policy, identifying provisions needing modification, and recommending comprehensive revisions. The committee has been asked to submit its recommendations within two months of its constitution. Experts state that a policy revision is imperative due to supply-chain resilience needs, critical mineral importance, and MMDR Act recasting. Industry representatives noted that global mining jurisdictions have revised policies around national priorities, prompting India's fresh review.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** New Delhi · **Who:** Mines Ministry, Additional Secretary in the Mines Ministry, B K Bhatia, Pankaj Satija · **Prelims:** The review panel consists of nine members.; The committee is chaired by the Additional Secretary in the Mines Ministry.; The panel must submit its recommendations within two months.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Helps India secure vital critical and strategic minerals necessary for modern industries and green energy transition.; Aims to attract advanced technologies and private investment into the domestic mining and exploration sector.*

Static — The National Mineral Policy aims to ensure more effective regulation, sustainable development of the mining sector, and address project-affected persons' concerns. The 2019 policy sought transparency, better enforcement, balanced social and economic growth, private investment, and ease of doing business. India has undertaken progressive initiatives including amendments to the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Geography, Governance & Policy, Infrastructure & Energy

Economic Times: read the source · *free copy on ptinews.com*

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

India’s first solar mission Aditya-L1 generates Doppler velocity images of the solar corona

ISRO's Aditya-L1 spacecraft successfully produced Doppler velocity imagery of the solar corona for the first time. these images are expected to provide information on the propagation of the coronal mass ejections along the Sun-Earth direction, which were unavailable till date

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** Lagrange Point 1 · **Who:** Aditya-L1 mission team / ISRO · **Prelims:** Aditya-L1 is India's first dedicated solar mission.; Generated Doppler velocity images to track coronal mass ejections along the Sun-Earth direction.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Fills a critical gap in space science by measuring coronal mass ejection velocity directed towards Earth.; Aids in improving predictive models for space weather events that can disrupt satellites and terrestrial power grids.*

Static — Aditya-L1 is India's first dedicated space-based solar observatory, launched by ISRO in September 2023 aboard a PSLV-XL rocket. The spacecraft is positioned in a halo orbit around the Sun-Earth Lagrange point 1 (L1), approximately 1.5 million kilometres from Earth. The L1 location provides the major advantage of continuously viewing the Sun without any occultation or eclipses.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Infrastructure & Energy, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

The Hindu: read the source

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Indian scientists develop new way to extract lithium from seawater

BARC scientists developed a chemical extraction technique capturing nearly 90 per cent of dissolved lithium from natural seawater. The innovation addresses India's complete reliance on imports for raw lithium and battery-grade cells amid rapid electric vehicle adoption. Seawater holds 230 billion tonnes of lithium, but extremely low concentration and high magnesium ratios make selective extraction difficult. The research was conducted at BARC's National Centre for Compositional Characterization of Materials in Hyderabad and published in Talanta. Researchers pre-treated seawater with sodium hydroxide and sodium carbonate, raising pH and removing over 99 per cent of magnesium and calcium. Lithium extraction utilised dibenzoyl methane dissolved in methyl isobutyl ketone (MIBK) at a low solvent-to-water ratio of 0.1. Dilute nitric acid was used to strip the extracted lithium, allowing solvent recycling over five cycles with 90 per cent recovery. Each cycle incurred a solvent loss of roughly 10 per cent, and issues like persistent foam formation require operational resolution. Commercial viability still depends on assessing industrial scalability, energy demands, chemical costs, and marine ecological impacts.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** Hyderabad, Telangana · **Who:** Scientists Vatsal Trivedi, Sai Krishna Devulapally, R Shekhar, and G Venkateswarlu at BARC · **Prelims:** Seawater contains an estimated 230 billion tonnes of lithium at a concentration of approximately 0.17 mg per litre.; The ratio of magnesium to lithium in natural seawater exceeds 6,000 to 1.; The extraction method uses dibenzoyl methane and methyl isobutyl ketone (MIBK) with dilute nitric acid for separation.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reduces supply chain vulnerabilities and foreign exchange outflows tied to critical mineral imports for India's EV sector.; Offers a less chemical-intensive alternative to traditional direct lithium extraction technologies.*

Static — Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC) is India's premier nuclear research facility, founded by Homi J. Bhabha in 1954 at Trombay, Mumbai. BARC operates under the Department of Atomic Energy (DAE), which reports directly to the Prime Minister of India. Lithium is the lightest solid element, alkali metal, highly reactive, and an essential critical mineral for high-density lithium-ion batteries.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Infrastructure & Energy

downtoearth.org.in: read the source

Defence

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Project-75I Moves Forward as TKMS, MDL Near Commercial Framework for Indian Navy's Six Stealth Submarines

The development is in the news as TKMS and MDL near a commercial framework for the Indian Navy's stealth submarine project. Project-75I has progressed significantly as TKMS and MDL move closer to establishing a commercial framework for building six stealth submarines for the Indian Navy.

When: 2026-10-20 · **Where:** India · **Who:** TKMS, Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL), Indian Navy · **Prelims:** Project-75I involves six stealth submarines for the Indian Navy.; The participating entities mentioned are TKMS and MDL.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Significantly enhances the underwater combat capabilities and strategic deterrence of the Indian Navy.; Boosts indigenous defence manufacturing through technology transfer under the Make in India initiative.*

Static — Project-75I is a strategic initiative under the Ministry of Defence to construct six conventional diesel-electric submarines featuring advanced Air Independent Propulsion (AIP) systems for the Indian Navy. The project is executed under the Ministry of Defence's Strategic Partnership model, which encourages domestic private and public shipyards to partner with foreign technology providers. Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Limited (MDL) is a premier public sector shipyard under the Ministry of Defence, located in Mumbai, India.

Syllabus: GS3: Defence, Governance & Policy

Defence.in: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

3 New Addition to The UNESCO World Heritage Tentative List

Three new Indian sites were added to the tentative list of the UNESCO World Heritage Convention, as announced by India's Permanent Delegation to UNESCO. The additions include the Karst-mud-volcano Complex of Baratang and Andaman Subduction Volcanoes in Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and the Sirpur Cultural and Archaeological Landscape in Chhattisgarh.

Times of India: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | ACT/BILL/RULES | PLACE IN NEWS | QUICK READ

Four years after notification, Nanjarayan Bird Sanctuary yet to get through transformation befitting Ramsar Site

Reports highlighting the delayed developmental and conservation upgrades four years post-notification brought the sanctuary into focus. Nanjarayan Bird Sanctuary has failed to undergo the necessary infrastructural and ecological transformation required for a Ramsar designated site four years after its notification.

The Hindu: source

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY | SCHEME | QUICK READ

Japan successfully launches probe in historic Mars moon mission

Japan successfully launched the unmanned Martian Moons eXploration (MMX) probe aboard its flagship H3 rocket from the Tanegashima Space Center. The launch took place on Tuesday at 4:41am local time, with the probe successfully separating from the rocket over an hour later to begin its journey.

The Hindu: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

Exercise AUSTRAHIND 2026

The 5th edition of the India-Australia Joint Military Exercise AUSTRAHIND 2026 commenced at Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala. The exercise aims to enhance military interoperability, operational coordination, and mutual trust between the Indian and Australian armies. It is an annual bilateral exercise instituted in 2022 and conducted alternately in India and Australia. India is represented by personnel from the Garhwal Rifles and other arms, while Australia is represented by its 13 Brigade.

ForumIAS: source

ECONOMY | ACT/BILL/RULES | QUICK READ

CBDT introduces Form 173A for tax exemption claims on government securities

The Central Board of Direct Taxes introduced Form 173A to report specified income-tax exemptions on interest and capital gains from government securities. The rule was issued via a Ministry of Finance notification on October 19 under the Income-tax (Seventh Amendment) Rules, 2026. Taxpayers claiming exemptions under Schedule IV, Table entries 13D and 13E of the Income-tax Act, 2025, must furnish this form.

BusinessLine: source

ECONOMY | SCHEME | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

Nippon Express Signs Strategic Cooperation MOU with India Semiconductor Mission for Chip Supply Chains

The strategic MOU was signed to enhance semiconductor supply chain logistics and support manufacturing growth in India. Nippon Express signed a strategic cooperation MOU with the India Semiconductor Mission to build robust chip supply chains.

LM - Logistics Manager: source

ECONOMY | QUICK READ

World Bank Launches First Digital Strategy

The World Bank Group launched its first comprehensive digital strategy, focusing on artificial intelligence, affordable internet access, and job creation. The initiative responds to the entry of 1.2 billion young people into the workforce in developing countries over the next 10 to 15 years. Announced in Seoul, the strategy combines public and private sector capabilities to expand digital connectivity and improve technology access in developing economies.

Insights on India: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS | QUICK READ

BIMSTEC adopts Delhi Declaration to counter-terrorism

The adoption of the declaration occurred during recent BIMSTEC diplomatic deliberations and summit meetings. BIMSTEC member nations adopted the Delhi Declaration to strengthen regional cooperation against terrorism and transnational crimes.

dailynews.lk: source

INFRASTRUCTURE & ENERGY QUICK READ

Wings of Change 10 Years of Redefining Regional Air Connectivity through UDAN

India's regional air connectivity scheme UDAN has enabled air travel for around 1.72 crore passengers and brought 687 routes into operation since its launch in October 2016. Regional air connectivity depends heavily on financial support in smaller markets where passenger traffic and airport revenues are insufficient for commercial viability. The core issue is expanding and sustaining affordable air travel to unserved and underserved regions while addressing infrastructure and viability challenges.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

Ladakh LG Notifies Regulation For Hill Councils In All 8 Districts

Ladakh Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena notified a regulation enabling Hill Development Councils in all eight districts of the Union Territory. The regulation follows the expansion of Ladakh's administrative structure, which increased the number of districts from two to eight. The Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (Amendment) Regulation, 2026, was promulgated by President Droupadi Murmu after Union Cabinet approval.

indiatoday.in: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

India to Become World’s Fourth-Largest Economy With Over $4 Trillion GDP in 2027: Check Latest IMF Rankings, Projections

India is projected to become the world’s fourth-largest economy by the year 2027, surpassing Japan according to IMF projections. The October 2026 IMF World Economic Outlook forecasts India’s nominal GDP to cross approximately $4.52 trillion in 2027. India will trail only behind the United States, China and Germany in the global rankings after overtaking Japan.

jagranjosh.com: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT APPOINTMENT QUICK READ

Calcutta HC says inquiry commission headed by retired judge be appointed into Chorbagan stampede

The Calcutta High Court directed the West Bengal government to set up an inquiry commission headed by a retired high court judge. The inquiry is meant to investigate the stampede at the Chorbagan Durga puja pandal that claimed 19 lives on October 17. The court noted that a sitting high court judge cannot be appointed to head the inquiry, rejecting the state government's proposal.

The Hindu: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Cabinet approves Rs. 15.07 Bn revised plan to complete Kolonnawa flood control project

The cabinet gave its official approval for the revised financial plan and completion strategy. The Cabinet approved a revised plan worth Rs. 15.07 billion to successfully complete the Kolonnawa flood control project.

Newswire: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Quad Summit to be held in Philippines next month: Rubio

The next edition of the Quad Summit is scheduled to take place on the margins of the ASEAN Summit in the Philippines next month. US Secretary of State Marco Rubio announced that the summit will happen during the ASEAN conference in Manila on November 16 to 17. Leaders expected to attend include Prime Minister Narendra Modi, US President Donald Trump, and leaders from Australia and Japan.

theprint.in: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Pakistan cuts GDP growth estimate to 3.65 per cent in fiscal year 2026

The Pakistan government revised its gross domestic product growth down to 3.65 per cent for the fiscal year 2026. The downward adjustment was attributed to a mild slowdown in the industrial and services sectors. The revision indicates that the country fell short of its earlier projected GDP growth target of 3.70 per cent and an initial 4 per cent estimate.

The Hindu: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Odisha leads as sugar inflation crosses 30% in 21 states and UTs

The release of the latest inflation data highlighting high retail sugar prices across multiple states put the commodity in the news. Retail sugar inflation hit a record 29.80 percent nationally in September under the new CPI series, while wholesale sugar inflation eased to 12.72 percent.

Business Standard: source

ECONOMY QUICK READ

Madhya Pradesh Semiconductor Summit 2026 to Be Held in Indore

The Madhya Pradesh Semiconductor Summit 2026 is scheduled to be held on 23-24 October 2026 at the Brilliant Convention Centre in Indore. The summit is led by Chief Minister Dr Mohan Yadav with the objective of attracting investment and developing the state as a semiconductor hub. The event aims to foster technological innovation and position Madhya Pradesh prominently in the domestic and international semiconductor sector.

drishtiias.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Cabinet Approves Drone Industry Strategy, Health Plan, Regulatory Changes

The Jordanian Cabinet approved the National Strategy for Localizing the Drone Industry in the Kingdom for 2026-2036. The strategy aims to transition Jordan from importing drone technology to domestic development, manufacturing, assembly, and testing. It covers software, electronics, communications, navigation, control systems, energy, airframes, and systems integration across five pillars. The Cabinet also approved the Ministry of Health Strategy for 2026-2030 to enhance healthcare quality, equity, and sustainability.

msn.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 Rupee and the price of dodging a century

The Indian rupee faced significant depreciation, touching 96.71 per US dollar in May 2026 and nearing the psychological mark of 100. Global uncertainty, rising crude oil prices, and massive foreign institutional investor outflows drove the depreciation. India imports about 90 percent of its fuel needs, creating heavy dollar demand, while net FII outflows hit 32.8 billion dollars in the first ten months of 2026. Foreign investors reallocated capital toward artificial intelligence and semiconductors, pulled by higher US interest rates and after booking gains.

BusinessLine

GS3 How technology is reshaping Asia's investment landscape

The publication of a latest Goldman Sachs report detailing Asia's rise as the world's second-largest equity bloc. An analysis of how technological advancements, particularly AI-driven semiconductor demand, are transforming Asian equity markets and investment prospects. Investing in Asia is no longer a one-size-fits-all proposition, with opportunities increasingly diverging across markets, sectors and themes, Goldman Sachs says in its latest report. Regional market capitalisation has climbed to nearly $50 trillion, making Asia the world's second-largest equity bloc.

BusinessLine

GS3 Beyond carbon pricing: India must build an ecosystem that helps industry translate climate ambition into industrial real

India is operationalising its domestic Carbon Credit Trading System to meet long-term industrial emissions reduction targets. The author argues that while India's Carbon Credit Trading System offers a carbon price signal, effective industrial decarbonisation requires a comprehensive policy mix including technology deployment, shared infrastructure, and affordable finance. The country's Carbon Credit Trading System provides a price signal, but industrial decarbonization requires a more complex policy mix beyond price signals for the deployment of emerging technologies, support infrastructure and access to affordable finance.

Mint

GS1 GS2 The past is as glorious as you care for it

The Supreme Court called out the authorities following reports of missing documents for Lal Mahal and encroachment threats on tombs in Zamrudpur. The Supreme Court rebuked the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and the Archaeological Survey of India over the poor preservation and neglect of historic landmarks like Lal Mahal and Zamrudpur tombs. Documents for Lal Mahal are reportedly missing, raising red flags about its preservation. Tombs in Zamrudpur face threats from encroachment, reflecting a troubling neglect of cultural heritage.

Economic Times

GS1 GS2 Gender inequality and the Nobel Prize

The topic remains relevant due to ongoing discussions surrounding gender disparity in prestigious global scientific and academic awards. The editorial examines the persistent issue of gender inequality in the distribution of Nobel Prizes and the underlying biases in academic recognition. Gender inequality and the Nobel Prize

Deccan Herald

GS3 Karnataka's marine policy needs leases

Karnataka launched the Marine Biotechnology Policy 2026-31 with a Rs 120-crore budget, a dedicated research institute, biotechnology zones, and a production-linked incentive to grow its blue bioeconomy from $2 billion to $6-8 billion by 2031. The core problem is that ocean cultivation spaces like seaweed farms are not exclusive, mortgageable, or securable, leaving farmers without long-term rights and banks hesitant to lend against crops.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Mint Quick Edit | China's once roaring economy is taking long to rise above middle-income level

China's economy is taking a long time to transition above the middle-income level, highlighted by its latest quarterly GDP growth figures. China's economic growth has slowed to 4.5 percent quarterly, with strong exports offset by a weak domestic demand slump. With quarterly GDP growth of 4.5%, China is running at the lower end of its annual target. Exports are doing well but domestic demand remains in a slump, slowing its final stretch to high-income status.

Mint

GS2 Migrant remittances & IMF loan have limits. Now Bangladesh must rebuild its institutions

Bangladesh migrant remittances hit a record $35.6 billion in the fiscal year ending June 2026, helping lift gross foreign exchange reserves to $37.6 billion. Bangladesh has requested a new IMF loan package worth between $4.5 billion and $5 billion following annual meetings in Bangkok. The core argument is that while remittances and external loans offer temporary relief, Bangladesh suffers from a weak financial sector and one of the lowest revenue-to-GDP ratios globally at around 7 per cent.

ThePrint

GS3 Unknown vulnerabilities: on the cybersecurity advisory by CERT-In

It is in the news due to the recent cybersecurity advisory issued by CERT-In highlighting unknown vulnerabilities. The editorial examines CERT-In's cybersecurity advisory and stresses the urgent need for India to enhance its data breach detection and prevention mechanisms. India must do better at detecting and preventing data breaches

The Hindu

GS2 GS3 Women entrepreneurs can power Asia's digital trade boom

Millions of women entrepreneurs across Asia are beginning to use e-commerce, digital payments and online services to reach markets beyond their borders. Digital trade can help women sell goods, provide remote services and grow businesses without needing physical shopfronts or international travel. Globally, digitally deliverable services accounted for 56% of global services exports, while business e-commerce sales reached US$28 trillion in 2024.

Economic Times

GS3 Pressing pause on the race to develop frontier AI isn't impossible—Here's what can be done

The piece appears amid ongoing debates among policymakers and experts regarding the safety risks of rapid frontier AI development. The editorial argues that pausing or restraining the development of frontier artificial intelligence is feasible and sustainable by targeting the supply chain of AI chips. Policy could exploit this industry's big chokepoint of AI-chip supply to restrain its development beyond the limits deemed safe. Whether there should be a pause is for policymakers to decide.

Mint

GS2 US blinks on Russia, India less fluttered

The US administration's decision to blink on Russia by issuing a sanctions waiver to protect domestic diesel supply ahead of midterms put the issue in the news. The United States has waived tougher sanctions on Russia to secure domestic diesel supplies ahead of midterm elections, though structural constraints on Russian refineries limit the real-world impact. Trump's decision to waive tougher sanctions against Russia aims to ensure US diesel supply until the midterm elections.

Economic Times

GS2 In battling childhood obesity, government policy may just tip the scales

On October 7, the WHO issued its first-ever guidelines for integrated management of obesity in children aged 29 days to under 10 years. Childhood obesity is driven by an energy imbalance from consuming high-fat, high-sugar foods and engaging in less physical activity. The core issue is a double burden of malnutrition where NCDs like Type 2 diabetes are appearing in younger populations. UNICEF's 2025 report noted that obesity among school-aged children and adolescents has surpassed underweight globally, affecting 188 million children.

msn.com

GS3 Can round-the-clock renewable power dethrone coal in India? Not unless innovation leads the way

An opinion piece discusses whether round-the-clock renewable energy can replace coal in India, arguing that technological innovation is essential. A recent tender for clean 24x7 power hit the news for its splendid supply price. Impressive as this is, it mustn't spell policy complacency. We need our own leaps of technology for affordable energy security.

Mint

GS2 Route mental health care through communities

Many countries have made progress in community-based mental health services and rights-based policy approaches. However, large numbers of people with mental health conditions still live in psychiatric hospitals and social care institutions. According to the WHO Mental Health Atlas, about half of institutionalized individuals were brought in against their will. Nearly half of all public mental health funding globally is spent on maintaining large standalone psychiatric facilities. Sri Lanka successfully transformed its mental health system from an asylum-based model to a decentralised district network.

Hindustan Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

Knowledge Nugget | India now has 103 Ramsar Sites: Why are wetlands important? The milestone was highlighted in an explainer examining the ecological importance of wetlands in India. India's tally of recognized Ramsar Sites of international importance has reached 103.
Indian Express

For voters deleted from rolls during SIR, why Form 6 remedy raises questions The debate gained traction following concerns raised over the cumbersome re-enrolment hurdles faced by voters whose names were removed during the Special Intensive Revision. An analysis of why relying on Form 6 as a remedy for voters wrongfully deleted from electoral rolls during the Special Intensive Revision raises serious procedural and constitutional questions.
Indian Express

Japan to Mars : What JAXA's rocket launch hopes to achieve The mission is in the news due to upcoming preparations and scientific objectives for Japan's interplanetary journey to Mars. Japan's space agency JAXA is undertaking a rocket launch to explore Mars and its moons to study planetary evolution.
Indian Express

China's new curbs on tunnel boring machines: What they mean for India China announced new export controls on tunnel boring machines and other key machinery to safeguard national security and interests. The restrictions were announced by China's Ministry of Commerce (MOFCOM) and will officially take effect on November 18.
news18.com

Mint Explainer: What do clean fuel regulations mean for car buyers? Growing policy pushes and discussions around tightening vehicular emission standards in India. An explainer detailing the implications of clean fuel regulations and emission norms for car buyers.
Mint

Kiwi fruit, sheep meat, honey and more… What gets cheaper as India-New Zealand FTA kicks in? The explainer was published following developments surrounding the India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement. An explainer covering the commodities, including kiwi fruit, sheep meat, and honey, expected to become cheaper as the India-New Zealand Free Trade Agreement takes effect.
Firstpost

Can changing your religion carry forward your caste reservation benefits? The persistent legal challenges and demands from various religious minority groups seeking inclusion in Scheduled Caste reservation quotas. An explainer detailing the legal and constitutional provisions regarding the retention of Scheduled Caste reservation benefits upon religious conversion.
The Hindu

Can India turn retrofitment into the next mobility revolution? Growing discussions around sustainable urban mobility, green jobs, and the economic potential of converting existing internal combustion vehicles into electric ones. An explainer on how vehicle retrofitment can drive a decentralized mobility revolution in India by empowering local mechanics and workshops.
The Hindu

When the machine gets it wrong, who pays? Recent AI errors reported in Australia, Singapore, and Bengaluru brought public attention to the lack of recourse when automated systems fail. Recent incidents of algorithmic failures across different countries highlight the urgent need for robust accountability, auditing, and appeal mechanisms for AI systems.
Frontline

All you need to know about: Leptospirosis It is in the news as an explainer detailing the nature, risks, and complications associated with the disease during susceptible seasons. Leptospirosis is a bacterial infection that mimics common monsoon illnesses but can cause life-threatening complications affecting the kidneys, liver, and lungs if not treated on time.
The Hindu

Who is Paul Mackenzie, the self-proclaimed pastor found guilty of starving over 190 children to death in ho... The legal proceedings and guilty verdict regarding the Shakahola forest mass starvation case brought the incident back into focus. Self-proclaimed pastor Paul Mackenzie was found guilty of starving over 190 children to death in a mass cult tragedy.
Firstpost

Explainer: Jantar Mantar and the Right to Protest at a Place Where the State Cant Easily Look Away On October 15, the Supreme Court issued notice on a petition by advocate Swaty Singh challenging the Delhi Police's decision to de-notification of Jantar Mantar as a designated protest site. The Delhi Police Commissioner signed the de-notification order on October 11, citing an MHA-constituted committee's recommendation following mass detentions during ongoing protests.
m.thewire.in

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

• Gender-Based Notification Of Delhi Teaching Posts: Supreme Court Seeks Affidavit (Social Justice & Welfare) LawChakra
• How Conversion Affects Reservation (Social Justice & Welfare) The Hindu

- India’s Nuclear Programme Dedicated to Peaceful Purposes, Says Union Minister Dr. Jitendra Singh; Nuclear Energy to Power AI-Driven Future (Science & Technology) PIB
- Chennithala seeks stringent NDPS Act, Centre-state initiative for drug-free India (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- Temple plea for elephant procession: Kerala HC says SC-fixed registration deadline can’t be extended by HC or govt (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Tamil Nadu government orders additional 25 days of guaranteed employment for vulnerable rural households (Governance & Policy) The Hindu
- Bengaluru-Mumbai Vande Bharat sleeper train likely to be launched on November 1 (Infrastructure & Energy) The Hindu
- India, Saudi Arabia discuss proposed electricity link, explore wider power cooperation (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- India’s Red List assessment of 1,211 birds underway; initial review of 100 birds complete (Environment & Ecology) Hindustan Times
- Precedents Barring Recovery Of Excess Payments Have Not Considered Section 72 Contract Act: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- Can you face criminal charges for criticising a Supreme Court judgment? Karnataka high court answers (Polity & Constitution) The Times of India
- Bipartisan Bill Proposes Permanent US-India Parliamentary Forum (International Relations) IndiaWest
- Cabinet approves scrapping BRT project, converting it into six-lane highway (International Relations) The Financial Express
- CBDT mandates new disclosures for tax-free gains on govt securities (Economy) Economic Times
- Nepal Finance Minister To Talk About Bilateral Opportunities At NDTV World Summit (International Relations) NDTV
- Kittur Rani Chennamma Jayanti 2026, Biography, Kittur Vijayotsava (History, Art & Culture) Vajiram & Ravi
- Indian Cybercrime Coordination Centre (Internal Security) Vajiram & Ravi
- India’s ‘Act East’ Needs Bangladesh to ‘Look East’ (International Relations) Institute Of South Asian Studies (ISAS-NUS)
- Records Of Prime Minister's Foreign Travel In IAF Aircraft Exempt From RTI : Delhi High Court Sets Aside... (Polity & Constitution) Live Law
- Three New Centipede Species Discovered in Western Ghats (Environment & Ecology) ForumIAS
- ASEAN and BRICS: where interests of two integration groups converge (International Relations) TV BRICS
- Valmiki Tiger Reserve Reopens: Four New Safari Routes Introduced As 500 Tourists Visit In Three Days (Environment & Ecology) Patna Press
- Pakistan, Saudi Arabia, Türkiye pact details collective defense framework (International Relations) Muslim Network TV
- Allahabad High Court Asks Centre, RBI How Dependants Can Access Bank Savings Of Coma Patients (Polity & Constitution) LawChakra
- Weaker watchdog, wider suffering? India’s draft animal-experiment rules spark welfare backlash (Governance & Policy) Mathrubhumi English
- Keralam seeks FSSAI clarity on high fat, sugar, salt food (Health) The Hindu
- Delhi University PhD Admission 2026: Check Exam Format, Marking Scheme And Interview (Education) NDTV
- How to prevent rainfall deficiency from becoming drought disaster (Disaster Management) Indian Express
- Baltic Sea: Location, Features and Environmental Issues UPSC (Geography) Insights on India
- “The decriminalisation of adultery reflects a shift from enforcing social morality to protecting constitutional morality.” Comment with reference to the evolving jurisprudence of the Supreme Court. (Polity & Constitution) Insights on India
- Govt working on central scheme on agrivoltaics (Agriculture & Allied) Hindustan Times
- Giant forest trees threatened by Great Nicobar mega project (Environment & Ecology) Frontline
- Rubio backs 'India's need to diversify' amid Russian oil purchase, says US can help meet energy need (International Relations) Hindustan Times
- India aims to increase size of its space economy fivefold in eight years (Science & Technology) TV BRICS
- Skyborne sentinels: How GSAT-7B gives the Indian Army its own eye in orbit (Defence) WION
- PM Modi appeals for unity as government seeks support for women’s reservation bill (Polity & Constitution) Business Upturn
- 'Expect partners to show zero tolerance on terrorism': EAM thanks US for handing over Tahawwur Rana (Internal Security) Times of India
- India Ranks 84th in Henley Passport Index 2026 (International Relations) www.usthadian.com
- On ECINet platform, access for States can be switched off and on centrally: report (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- In second visit within months, Rubio calls on India to scale up US energy and defence buys (International Relations) Economic Times
- India’s strategic oil reserves: The urgent need to add capacity (Economy) The Financial Express
- Gunmen kill 3 in Imphal east, angry locals leave 2 bodies outside CM's residence (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- Report of the expert committee on Storage Part I (Governance & Policy) NITI Aayog
- World falls behind on 2030 nature goals as finance divides nations at COP17 (Environment & Ecology) The Climate Watch
- Rubio says U.S. to discuss refining Venezuelan crude with Reliance, adds India made ‘substantial progress’ in diversifying energy supplies (International Relations) The Hindu
- More than 30 sewer, septic tank deaths reported so far in 2026; compensation paid in nine cases: NCSK (Social Justice & Welfare) Hindustan Times

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 18 must-know, 18 Prelims facts, 46 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Economy (13), International Relations (7), Polity & Constitution (5), Science & Technology (3), Governance & Policy (3), Defence (2), Environment & Ecology (2), Infrastructure & Energy (1). **Nothing today in —** Social Justice & Welfare, Health, Education, Agriculture & Allied, Internal Security, Disaster Management, History, Art & Culture, Geography, Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 1 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: nothing today · Political change in the neighbourhood: nothing today · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: nothing today

Full text — 31 of 63 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — The Hindu 9, Economic Times 7, Mint 5, Hindustan Times 3, BusinessLine 3, Indian Express 3, PIB 2, jagranjosh.com 2, Business Standard 2, Frontline 2, msn.com 2, Deccan Herald 2, Firstpost 2, lokmattimes.com 1

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